

Alex Mercer

Staff Distributed Systems Engineer

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Professional Summary

Distributed systems engineer with 8+ years experience building low-latency transaction routing pipelines and fault-tolerant storage engines.

Work Experience

Senior Software Engineer

2021-03 – Present

Stripe (<https://stripe.com>)

Core Infrastructure team focusing on transaction routing & consensus systems.

- Architected multi-region failover pipeline reducing P99 latency by 35ms across 12B daily events.
- Led migration of primary ledger database from Aurora Postgres to distributed CockroachDB with zero downtime.
- Authored custom Raft-based consensus layer in Go for distributed state synchronization.

Software Engineer II

2018-06 – 2021-02

Cloudflare (<https://cloudflare.com>)

Edge Workers and DDoS mitigation infrastructure.

- Engineered packet filtering daemon in Rust processing 40M packets/sec with sub-millisecond overhead.
- Co-designed edge rate-limiting pipeline saving \$180k/month in origin bandwidth egress costs.

Education

University of Washington

2014-09 – 2018-06

B.S. in Computer Science | GPA: 3.88 / 4.0

Relevant Coursework: Distributed Systems, Operating System Internals, Advanced Networking, Database System Concepts

Technical Skills

Languages: Rust, Go, Python, C++, SQL

Infrastructure & Systems: Distributed Systems, Kafka, CockroachDB, Kubernetes, gRPC, Redis, Linux eBPF

Projects

Chronos Raft

 (<https://github.com/alexmercer/chronos-raft>)

2023-01 – 2023-08

High-performance embeddable Raft consensus engine in Rust.

- Benchmarked throughput at 150k ops/sec with deterministic network partition testing via Jepsen.

Certifications

- **Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)** – Cloud Native Computing Foundation (2022-05)